tual Computing SDK will help developers push forward toward that goal. Much like the way touch technology on mobile devices quickly gained momentum, wide-scale multi-modal perceptual computing is likely to be available soon. The ecosystem has evolved rapidly over the last 10 years, thanks to a surge of tools and computing power, dubbed by Nanduri as, "an innovation hockey stick."

Intel's support and creation of the Intel Perceptual Computing SDK shows a dedication to the expansion of computing technology. Because Intel, and companies such as Nuance, Total Immersion, and SoftKinect, created the SDK to be powerful and easy to use, application developers in all areas of expertise will be able to integrate and experiment with voice and gesture technology.

Productivity

Create a way to do things faster, better, and easier. Select this category if you've utilized the perceptual computing usage modes (i.e. finger/hand tracking, speech recognition, facial analysis or 2D/3D object tracking) to enhance a user's ability to accomplish tasks with a non-gaming application. Keep in mind that it's not necessary to REPLACE mouse and keyboard, but you want to use perceptual computing usages to ENHANCE a user's ability to accomplish a task.

Creative User Experience

Select this category if you've developed an innovative means for users to interact with applications using any combination of the perceptual computing usage modes (i.e. finger/hand tracking, speech recognition, facial analysis or 2D/3D object tracking) or even a single usage mode. Create an interaction that is memorable and innovative for the user.

The combination of voice, facial recognition, and gesture will truly revolutionize the human-computer interface and help remove many of the computing boundaries today. Users of all skill types and knowledge levels will be able to effectively and efficiently interact with their devices to extract information and transparently get the results they want. The power and potential of perceptual computing are now beginning to take hold. In the coming years, watch for exciting developments that will transform the way we interact and use our computers and mobile devices.

INNOVATION AND PERCEPTUAL COMPUTING CONTEST

Intel created a USD 1 million innovation contest to feature the best examples of what's possible with the Intel® Perceptual Computing Software Development Kit. This contest invites developers to be wildly creative with human-computer interaction designs. The ecosystem has many creative ideas for new interface technologies, and Intel is hoping to channel them into a public forum of collaboration. As with any new computing technology, Intel is looking for the handful of applications that will pop out of the screen, impress new consumers, and draw them into the scaling benefits of perceptual computing. To learn more about the contest, see: www.intel.com/software/perceptual

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

A contributing writer, roving reporter, podcast host, and blogger for the popular technology site PC Perspective, Ryan Shrout researches and writes product reviews for today's leading-edge hardware and software products. When he's not tracking down the pending changes to the various CPU and compute architectures, Ryan is on tap to assist the RH+M3 group when the need for a hardcore computer-geek writer arises.